IAL - Structure grid (All)

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'Explain' – 4 mark questions *(1 knowledge, 2 application, 1 analysis marks)*	'Calculate'– 4 mark questions *(Knowledge 1, Application 3)*	'Construct'– 4 mark questions *(1 knowledge, 2 application, 1 analysis marks)*
• **An 'explain'** question requires you to provide a brief explanation of cause or effect, which is supported by details or example(s) from the case context. • **Knowledge of your point** – demonstrate understanding • **Application** – Direct reference to context & not just copying text from case study. • **Analysis** – What is impact, cause, effect of your point	• **A 'calculate'** question requires you to perform a calculation, based on given data. Workings should be given. • Answer needs to be given in 2 decimal places and include currency / % signs/ units	• **A 'construct'** question requires you to draw an accurately labelled diagram. • **Application/analysis** – should show correct changes in market conditions

Assess Two (8 marks)
(2 knowledge, 2 application, 2 analysis, 2 evaluation)

- This requires two possible advantages. There is only a maximum of 2 knowledge marks here for listing advantages.
- There is then a further application mark available for each advantage/benefit/drawback linked to case study.
- A further 2 analysis marks are available for each advantage/benefit/drawback showing the cause or consequence. Good terms to use are 'this leads to', 'this can affect … by…'.
- **To access Level** 3 You are expected to give a balance your argument. E.g. 'discuss the benefits…', you are still expected to balance your answer, e.g. explain why it might **not** be a benefit.
- To get into **Level 3**, you are expected to have an awareness of competing arguments leading to a supported judgement.

'Assess' questions (10 marks) (Knowledge 2, Application 2, Analysis 3, Evaluation 3)	'Assess' questions (12 marks) (Knowledge 2, Application 2, Analysis 4, Evaluation 4)
• Require **TWO** balanced points with a conclusion, in that they need to be **'wide-ranging'**, have **'a coherent chain of reasoning'** and **'supported judgement'.** • You need to have developed **chains of arguments** that are contextualised with **balance of benefits and drawbacks** to get into Level 4. All analytical **chains of impact** need to have a **Start & End** with context. • Explain how your argument could have an **impact on the operations** of the business i.e. productivity, motivation, pricing, branding, labour etc. • A conclusion must be provided with a 10-mark question. • Ensure you've answered the question	• Require more than the 10-mark answers, in that they need to be **'wide-ranging', This means THREE points that are full relevant to the context/behaviour of the business.** • You need to have developed **chains of arguments** that are fully contextualised with **balance that shows an awareness of competing arguments-** these cannot be one sided. • All analytical **chains** need to have a **Start & End,** linked to context • Explain how your argument could have an **impact on the operations** of the business i.e. productivity, motivation, pricing, branding, labour etc. • A conclusion must be provided with a **however point** that leads to supported judgment on how your recommendations impacts on **operational decisions** of the business behaviours.

'Evaluate' - 20-mark essay question
Knowledge 4, Application 4, Analysis 6, Evaluation 6

1. Read the question and underline key concepts
   - Identify if there is a dual topic, "elements" – For example, Do you think retailers such as Souq and Noon now need to focus more on promotion rather than other elements of the market mix to increase market share. (I.e. marketing mix of promotion to increase market share)
2. Make your **POINT x2** and give analysis relating to the case study (data) **(Point, Evidence) –DEVLOP** your chains of knowledge by linking back to the question and impact on the business
   - If this was true what could be the **consequences** (analysis)
   - **Evaluate** throughout. Whys this point? Why valid? What is better of this? (point, give analysis, context & link to the business)
   - Make **judgement** after each point. i.e. what behavior would they have to consider
     - Why does this point answer the question?
     - What does this point show us? Why is this useful? What could the business have to consider within its operations
3. Give a **counter argument** x2 to each of your point
   - Why something may not be better? If it was what would /would not happen?
   - What behavior would the business have to consider
4. **Evaluation** – conclusion must answer the question
   - Always start off with, "I think that……" This shows **JUDGEMENT** (give a statement)
     - LINK and demonstrate **JUSTIFICATION** in your conclusion (LINK). Why? i.e. what are the objectives of the business? You should aim to make a judgment for the business. What are their goals linked to their needs? Back up/validate it/ what is the context of reaching this decision?
     - **Justification x 2** - why is it more important than others? What would be long/short term choice how this response meets objectives.
     - Why is the factor better in this situation?
     - Why does this factor/point win? Why is one agreement better than the other (judgment)
     - Short term /Long term – how could this affect the business decision/behavior

write more contextualised responses

S	Size & Sector	e.g. Revenues, Profits, Manufacturer, Service
C	Costs, Customers & Competitive Environment	e.g. Fixed, Variable, Customer Groups, Market, Competitors
O	Ownership & Objectives	e.g. Private, Public, Profit, Sales Maximisation
R	Resources	e.g. Finance, IP, People, Products, Services
E	External Environment	e.g. Legislation, Economy, Technology

Useful for application of qualitative information

P	Patterns	Are there any patterns or trends in the data?
A	Anomalies	Is there anything unusual about the data that stands out?
D	Data Manipulation	Can you manipulate the data to make it more useful?
L	Links and Limitations	Can you link different pieces of data together? What are the limitations of the data?
S	Support	How can you use the data to support your arguments?

Useful for quantitative data

LINKED STRAND CONNECTIVES		IT DEPENDS ON IDEAS	
Because	Which might	Long term	Liquidity
Leads to	Equally	Short term	Staff skills
Therefore	Whereas	Economics environment	Organisational structure
As a result	Instead of	Stakeholder Support	Leadership
Consequently	Clearly	Objectives of the business	Culture of the business
Which could	Unlike	What are the competition doing	GDP
		Access to finance	Consumer income
		Productivity	Product portfolio

TERMS OTHER THAN PROFIT	
Competitive advantage	Economics of Scale
Motivated Employees	Better reputation
Brand Loyalty	Brand awareness
Satisfied Stakeholders	Dividends
Gross/operating/net profit margins	Number of customers
Higher market share	Break even analysis
Productivity	Cash flow
